

Number of matches played after 2023 ODI WC final

	India	Australia	South Africa	Pakistan	England	Afghanistan	New Zealand	Bangladesh
Test	17	14	12	12	17	4	14	12
ODI	9	12	14	11	14	14	11	12
T20I	38	26	25	27	27	23	25	27

latter being included.

Then came the comment from Shreyas Iyer — who scored a match-winning fifty — after the game, stating that he was not supposed to play in Nagpur but was drafted in due to Virat Kohli's injury. This indicated India's intention to break its battle-hardened ODI batting spine and introduce Yashasvi Jaiswal as Rohit Sharma's opening partner, pushing Shubman Gill and Kohli down the order.

Also in the spotlight was the surprise inclusion of mystery spinner Varun Chakaravathy in the ODI squad for the England series. Indian skipper Rohit Sharma hinted ahead

of the opening game that the Tamil Nadu tweaker could make a late dash for the Champions Trophy squad, depending on his performances against England.

Varun's last-minute introduction into the mix came on the back of his impressive performances in T20Is, which has been India's primary focus in recent times.

Since the last ODI World Cup final, India has played 38 T20Is — the second-most in the world. Interestingly, 20 of them have come after India's T20 World Cup win in June. This is despite the fact that the next edition of the 20-over World Cup is over a year away.

To top it off, India has also played 17 Tests in the last 14 months — only England has played as many red-ball games in this period.

India's lackadaisical approach to its preparation for the Champions Trophy is not just detrimental to its prospects in the tournament.

With T20 franchise leagues popping up like mushrooms and Test cricket experiencing a roaring revival, the ODI format is fighting a losing battle to stay relevant. Any sign of disinterest from India, the financial powerhouse of world cricket, could be the death knell for the 50-over game.

All numbers up to Feb12, 2025

India's preparation run for the last four ICC ODI tournaments

Matches played and players used in ODIs in the 12 months before each tournament

Matches Players

